

Single Source Justification (Simplified Acquisition)

Section A: General Contract Information

Is this a Bridge Action as defined in the [AF Bridge Action Reduction Plan](#)?☐ Yes☒ No

Contracting Activity: AFRL/PZLET

Project/Program Name: AFRL/RQVS Altair Software Renewal

Purchase Request / Local ID Number: [REDACTED]

Estimated Contract Cost (including Options): \$ [REDACTED]

Section B: Description of the Supplies/Services Required

This is a single source requirement for procurement of Altair licenses and maintenance that is essential to sustain the government's structural analysis and optimization capabilities. RQVS/RQVC has employed Altair for over 10 years in simulation, analysis, and optimization initiatives for structural improvement. This commercial off-the-shelf Finite Element Analysis package offers robust structural analysis capabilities and the unique ability to incorporate user-defined functions, enabling specialized analyses that are central to RQVS and RQVC mission requirements.

Contract Type: FFP

Funding: FY25 [REDACTED] & [REDACTED] funds.

Acquisition: Sole Source Standalone Purchase Order Contract

Section C: Justification for Soliciting from a Single Source or Brand Name

The specific exception that requires a brand-name exception for this acquisition is FAR 13.1. The procurement of Altair licenses and maintenance is essential to support the government's current structural analysis capability. Altair has become a critical component of RQVS and RQVC for structural analysis/optimization capability for more than 10 years. As a commercial-off-the-shelf (COTS) item Finite Element Analysis package, it provided a robust structural analysis capability at its core along with an industry leading structural optimization capability that is critical to RQVS and RQVC mission requirements.

The licenses for these products are shared over multiple computers and computational platforms such as Linux and Windows operating environments. AFRL/RQ asserts that procurement of any other brand would result in substantial additional cost to the Government that is not expected to be recovered through competition and unacceptable delays and coverage gaps in fulfilling RQ's mission. Within the Aerospace Systems Directorate, RQ, past finite element models and structural designs have been developed using modules within the Altair.

Purchasing a potential replacement would incur a considerable additional expense, due to training and redevelopment of models and codes for a new software suite. Beyond overcoming not having access to Altair's unique structural optimization tool sets, technical work would also be delayed by several years if a new software suite were to be implemented. It is estimated that the cost to develop coded with Altair's unique topology optimization capability would add at least an additional \$ [REDACTED] - \$ [REDACTED] just in labor costs plus the cost of an alternative software package. This figure was based on a research assistant man-hour estimate of approximately 1.5 - 2 man-year and does not include the indirect costs to the government caused by program delays in the sponsored research supported by this software package. These costs could not be recouped through competition.

Section D: Efforts to Obtain Competition

Due to its proprietary nature, Altair Engineering, Inc. is the sole developer and provider of the Altair Enterprise

Single Source Justification (Simplified Acquisition)

software, there are no third-party vendors that offer this product. As such, it is not possible to obtain competition for this product through traditional means, such as publishing a request for information (RFI).

Altair Enterprise Tokens are not available on GSA or BPA pricing and a search on DoD ESI confirms Altair does not have an agreement in place with the DoD.

In an effort to obtain competition, we have explored alternative means of procuring the Altair Enterprise software but have been unable to identify any viable options. Given these circumstances, it is our determination that competition for this product is not feasible, and that a single source acquisition is necessary.

Section E: Steps to Preclude Future Single Source or Brand Name Awards

To the best of the government's ability, the leading competing products available in the current market place have been evaluated prior to purchasing the solution. AFRL/RQVS will continue to monitor the market to determine if other products meet the government's needs. AFRL/RQVS will continue to conduct market research using catalogues, the internet, attend industry events, trade journal searches, market surveys and other resources to locate other solutions to meet the government's requirements.

Section F: Contracting Officer's Determination

I have determined, in accordance with [FAR 13.106-1\(b\)\(1\)](#), that the circumstances of this contract action deem only a single source is reasonably available.

Date 15-Apr-2025	Typed Name and Rank/Grade of Contracting Officer [REDACTED]	Signature of Contracting Officer [REDACTED] Digitally signed by [REDACTED] Date: [REDACTED]
---------------------	--	--